

[Report 008] GitLab - Engagement Manager, EMEA

Score: 3.2/5
Culture Fit: Moderate
URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/gitlab/jobs/8467462002>
PDF: 
Legitimacy: High Confidence
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Field	Detail
Archetype	AI Forward Deployed / Technical AI PM (hybrid - pre-sales professional services)
Domain	DevSecOps, professional services, enterprise software
Function	Consult, sell, manage
Seniority	Senior (progressive experience required)
Remote	Fully remote, EMEA
Team size	Professional Services team (size not specified)
TL;DR	Senior pre-sales professional services role: structure, scope, and sell complex DevSecOps implementation engagements across EMEA - runs discovery, writes SOWs, manages escalations, and bridges sales and delivery.

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD Requirement	CV Evidence	Fit
Design outcome-based professional services engagements	Project & Program Management (Expert): "program planning, financial administration, budget management, grant writing, reporting to stakeholders" across university and lab programs	Moderate - Christiaan designs programs but not commercial PS engagements (SOWs, staffing plans)
Partner with account executives and solutions architects	Stakeholder Alignment (Expert): multi-stakeholder alignment across Windesheim, Aeres, Open Food Chain, Viridis	Strong on facilitation; no named AE/SA partnership experience
Conduct discovery sessions with prospects and Systems Integrators	Workshop Design & Facilitation (Expert); Windesheim Supply Chain Finance practitioner interviews (current engagement)	Strong on discovery facilitation; weaker on enterprise sales-cycle discovery
Develop custom-scoped SOWs and staffing plans	No direct SOW authoring experience	Weak - genuine gap
Manage escalations through commercial processes	KONGSBERG: "read the contract, went to the CEO" (data integrity breach story); COTIT operational restructure	Partial - escalation management in non-commercial contexts
Understand software development lifecycle practices	DevOps (Expert, 10+ years): Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub, Jenkins; full DevOps lifecycle across all lab environments	Strong
Executive-level communication	KONGSBERG C-suite escalation; Windesheim lectoraat stakeholder reporting; Aeres faculty alignment	Strong

Facilitation and negotiation expertise	Workshop Design & Facilitation (Expert); market stall negotiation (Albert Cuyp); COTIT role restructure	Strong
Comfortable in remote, async environments	All current roles are remote or multi-site; uses async tools across distributed teams	Strong
Progressive experience in pre-sales PS	No direct pre-sales PS experience; closest is KONGSBERG client-facing BI delivery	Weak - this is the key structural gap

Gaps

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
SOW authoring and commercial scoping	Moderate blocker - this is a core deliverable of the role	Frame Windesheim grant proposals and COTIT SaaS restructure documentation as analogous scoping documents; acknowledge the commercial context is new
Pre-sales professional services experience	Moderate - GitLab will be looking for someone who has worked in a PS sales cycle before	Lead with KONGSBERG on-site client delivery + COTIT as the closest equivalent; be direct about the gap
DevSecOps product expertise (GitLab-specific)	Nice-to-have - GitLab is trainable	10+ years CI/CD and DevOps infrastructure; GitHub, Jenkins, Docker/Kubernetes - the domain is known, the product is learnable
Systems Integrator relationship management	Nice-to-have	No direct SI channel experience

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior individual contributor - GitLab uses "Engagement Manager" for a consultative pre-sales role that requires progressive PS deal-structuring experience.

Christiaan's natural level for this archetype: He can run the facilitation, discovery, and delivery management components at this level. The commercial PS deal mechanics (SOW authoring, staffing plans, services pricing, revenue recognition) are an adjacent skill he has not practiced in a commercial context.

Sell senior without lying:

- Open with the facilitation and discovery muscle: "I have run discovery and designed implementation programs in complex, multi-stakeholder environments - across universities, innovation labs, and funded initiatives. The format is different (grant vs. SOW) but the discipline is the same."
- Lean on KONGSBERG client delivery as the closest equivalent to PS delivery.
- Acknowledge the commercial PS context as a step up - but position it as a natural evolution: "I know how to design the program; I'm here to learn how to price it."

If downlevelled: Accept if compensation is fair and the first 6 months include a formal PS methodology mentorship component.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Metric	Data	Source
GitLab Engagement Manager EMEA (no published range for EU)	US equivalent: \$100,000 - \$150,000; EU typically 15-25% lower	GitLab careers page / Glassdoor
GitLab compensation reputation	Known for transparent pay bands, equity, and async-first culture	Glassdoor 4.2/5, high employee satisfaction
Christiaan's target	€65,000 - €90,000 EUR	_profile.md
Demand trend	Professional services roles at DevSecOps companies growing with enterprise AI adoption	Market context

Assessment: Compensation is likely to be within target range for EMEA. GitLab's all-remote structure is fully compatible with Baarn base. The equity component is meaningful given GitLab's public company status (\$GTLB).

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current Status	Proposed Change	Why			
1	Summary	Generic bridge-builder framing	Reframe as: "Senior practitioner in discovery-to-delivery cycles - structured complex programs for universities, labs, and funded initiatives. Now applying that operating model to enterprise PS engagements."	Mirrors GitLab's "discovery through delivery transition" language			
2	KONGSBERG section	Listed chronologically	Pull a headline bullet: "Client-facing delivery for BP and Statoil: full implementation from scoping through user training - hardware, software, dashboards, sign-off"	Establishes prior client delivery credibility			
3	DevOps skills	Buried in skills section	Surface Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub - these are GitLab's core product domain	Signals native fluency in the product area			
4	Stakeholder alignment	Skills bullet	Add specific example: "Aligned faculty, funding bodies, and technical teams across 8-course restructure at Aeres Hogeschool - from concept to delivery in under 2 months"	Shows the complexity of stakeholder management at scale			
5	LinkedIn	Not specified	Add "Professional Services	DevSecOps	Remote EMEA	Enterprise Engagement" to headline	Mirrors GitLab's vocabulary

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	STAR+R Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
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1	Discovery sessions with complex stakeholders	Windesheim AI practitioner interviews (current)	Supply Chain Finance lectoraat needed to understand AI tool adoption among practitioners	Interview 20+ practitioners to map current tool landscape and identify gaps	Designed structured interview protocol, ran interviews, synthesized findings into adoption map	Ongoing - delivering insights to inform lab direction	Discovery quality depends on the questions you don't ask; I build interview guides that leave room for unexpected answers
2	Design outcome-based service engagements	COVID-19 Mega Project	Windesheim needed to continue education during lockdown with 8 separate courses	Merge into one coherent interdisciplinary simulation in weeks	Designed the program structure, stakeholder map, and delivery timeline	Program ran successfully; model became a template for future cross-course design	Outcome-first design is harder than activity-first - most people start with "what will we do" and I start with "what will participants be able to do"
3	Executive-level communication	KONGSBERG CEO escalation	Data integrity breach at oil rig site - no internet, no escalation path	Resolve without losing the client relationship	Read the original contract, identified the breach, escalated directly to CEO with documentation	Breach was acknowledged and resolved	The lesson is: know the contract before you start. The accountability conversation is easier when you have the source document in hand
4	Manage escalations through commercial processes	COTIT operational restructure	Logistics startup with no defined processes, conflicting stakeholder priorities	Restructure roles and workflows without triggering resignation wave	Ran individual stakeholder conversations, mapped dependencies, restructured in phases	Operational clarity in 6 months, no departures	Restructuring is an escalation-management problem - the way you handle the first difficult conversation sets the tone for everything that follows
5	Cross-functional bridge (sales + delivery)	Open Food Chain community + investor bridge	Technical community needed to connect with investor audience	Translate complex blockchain protocol into accessible narrative	Simplified documentation, ran onboarding sessions for new backers, bridged technical and business vocabularies	New investment secured	The translation problem is always underestimated - you need to be fluent in both languages, not just the technical one
6	Remote async collaboration	All current roles	Every role since 2020 has been multi-site or fully remote	Operate effectively without co-location	Built async documentation, sprint rituals, and reporting frameworks for distributed teams	No delivery failures attributable to remote friction	Async works when the written artifacts are good enough to replace the conversation - I

							invest in documentation before I invest in meetings
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Red-flag questions:

- "Have you written commercial SOWs before?" - "Not in a named commercial PS context. My closest equivalent is grant proposal writing (€2M+ secured) and COTIT's operational scoping documents - both required structured scope definition, deliverable mapping, and stakeholder sign-off. I know the discipline. The commercial pricing layer is new and I would want mentorship on that in the first 6 months."
- "Do you have experience with GitLab specifically?" - "I run CI/CD pipelines and have used GitHub extensively. GitLab's architecture is something I would ramp on fast - the DevOps domain is my home ground. I would spend the first 2 weeks doing a self-paced GitLab certification."

Recommended case study: Aeres 8-course merge - shows complex stakeholder alignment, program design from scratch, and delivery under time pressure. Maps directly to "translating complex initiatives into measurable outcomes."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	Active Greenhouse board posting with full JD content	Positive
Apply button state	Active via Greenhouse job board	Positive
JD specificity	Specific: names SOW, staffing plans, EMEA, DevSecOps, engagement lifecycle stages	Positive
Company hiring signals	GitLab (\$GTLB) is a public company with active PS expansion; no major layoffs in PS division	Positive
Salary transparency	No range listed for EMEA (US ranges published separately)	Neutral
Reposting pattern	No prior history in scan-history.tsv	Neutral
Role market context	Senior PS Engagement Manager roles take 6-10 weeks to fill; seniority explains longer timeline	Positive
Remote EMEA	Fully remote - open to all EMEA timezone candidates, no relocation required	Positive

Context notes: GitLab is known for genuine all-remote hiring; this is not a nominal "remote" role. The PS team is active and growing with enterprise AI adoption driving DevSecOps platform demand. High confidence this is a real opening.

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: Public company (NASDAQ: GTLB), all-remote, async-first, high-documentation culture. GitLab is one of the most mature remote-first companies in the world - the async-first principle is not a policy choice, it is a deeply embedded cultural value backed by a public handbook that runs to thousands of pages. The Professional Services team is a well-defined function within a large organization.

Culture signals: GitLab's culture signals are clear from its public handbook and Glassdoor reputation: high autonomy, high documentation expectations, results-over-presence, direct communication, trust-based management. The JD language is specific and outcome-oriented ("progressive experience structuring and selling professional services," "develop custom-scoped SOWs"). This is a company that values precision and accountability.

Physical/work environment: Fully remote, EMEA. No office requirement, no commute. This is structurally ideal for Baarn-based work and for the multi-engagement model's geographic flexibility.

Match against 2-year vision: GitLab as a company is not a hackerspace - it is a large, public enterprise software company. However, the Engagement Manager role within Professional Services has a discovery-and-design dimension that partially maps to building things from scratch (every new client engagement is a new program). The all-remote culture respects autonomy. The team size within PS EMEA is likely small (10 to 20 people). The "new territory" dimension is present in each new client deployment. Alignment is moderate: the company is large but the role has enough variation and design authority to sustain interest.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Starter-heavy: every new engagement is a discovery and design cycle; then hand off to delivery	ENFP-T starter, strongest 0 to 1 and 1 to 2	Good - the engagement lifecycle resets with each new client
Variety vs. repetition	High variety: different clients, different industries, different deployment contexts across EMEA	Thrives on variety	Good match
Autonomy level	High: individual contributor with full engagement ownership	Needs ownership, not execution-only	Good match
Build vs. maintain	Build the engagement (discovery to SOW to delivery handoff) - then it resets	Builder identity	Good - the role structure prevents pure maintenance
Fractional fit	Full-time IC role; but remote flexibility may allow selective parallel work	Optimal: 2 to 3 concurrent 0.4 to 0.6 FTE	Moderate - full-time IC but remote flexibility creates some room
Energy spike tolerance	GitLab's high-documentation culture means the energy spike needs to be channeled into written artifacts, not just verbal enthusiasm	Front-loaded high energy	Moderate - the async-first culture rewards written output, not just energy
Team size	PS EMEA team - likely small within a large org	Small team preference	Moderate - small team within large company structure

H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

GitLab's mission - enabling software developers to collaborate and ship faster - is not Christiaan's frontier passion. DevSecOps tooling is important but not intrinsically exciting to him. The Engagement Manager role's connection to what he cares about is indirect: helping organizations implement new capabilities (DevSecOps) connects to the transformation methodology, but it is a tool-implementation context rather than a learning innovation or AI adoption context.

This is a moderate intrinsic connection at best. The genuine motivators here are: fully remote structure enabling the multi-engagement model's flexibility, the discovery-and-design work at the start of each engagement, the variety across EMEA clients, and the public company equity and compensation. The async-first culture also fits the working style well. Valid to pursue but not a mission-driven role.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers for this role:

- Every new client engagement is a fresh discovery and design cycle - the role resets the "new thing" feeling repeatedly
- Fully remote enables the multi-engagement model's flexibility in off-hours
- EMEA scope means variety in client contexts, industries, and stakeholder types
- Discovery facilitation is a core skill Christiaan does well and enjoys
- GitLab's transparent culture and documented processes reduce political friction

Likely drains:

- SOW authoring and commercial scoping - administrative and commercial mechanics are a drain, not an energizer
- GitLab's high-documentation culture requires producing precise written deliverables consistently - not the chaotic creative mode that energizes
- Large company structure means change and decisions move slower than in a startup

- DevSecOps domain is not intrinsically exciting - the work is tools implementation, not frontier innovation
- The pre-sales component (partnering with AEs on business cases) has some solo commercial pressure

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Rating: Sustainable, with caveat.

The engagement lifecycle structure - discovery, SOW, delivery handoff, next client - means the role naturally resets and avoids the maintenance trap. Each new client is a new context. The fully remote structure enables the multi-engagement flexibility Christiaan values. The EMEA scope provides genuine variety. At 18 months, the likely challenge is: has the commercial PS mechanics (SOW authoring, pricing, services selling) become routine enough to feel like repetition? If GitLab continues to expand into new enterprise AI contexts, the role stays fresh. If it settles into a standard DevSecOps implementation playbook, engagement may plateau.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	No	n/a	Engagement lifecycle resets - built-in variety
Solo sales of an unready product	Low risk	Low	Product is ready (GitLab); AE co-pilots the commercial side
Full-time exclusivity expected	Partial	Low	IC role but fully remote - some flexibility possible
Large corporate, slow decision cycles	Moderate	Medium	Public company with defined processes - not a startup
Governance/board role in declining org	No	n/a	Growing company
Ceremony-only Scrum Master	No	n/a	Not a Scrum role

H7 - Fit Verdict

The honest case for this match:

The Engagement Manager role structure - repeated discovery and design cycles with different EMEA clients - matches Christiaan's starter-not-finisher pattern better than most roles in this batch. The fully remote structure is the best geographic and lifestyle fit available. The EMEA variety prevents the repetition trap. GitLab's async-first culture respects autonomy and produces a written artifact culture that suits Christiaan's systematic documentation instinct. The facilitation and discovery muscles are a direct match. If the SOW authoring gap can be closed in the first 6 months (with mentorship, as noted in the report), this role could be sustainable for 2 to 3 years.

The honest case against:

The DevSecOps domain is not frontier for Christiaan - this is tools implementation, not learning innovation or AI frontier work. The commercial PS mechanics (SOW, staffing plans, services pricing) are genuinely new territory and will require a learning curve that may feel slow. The company is large enough that individual decisions move at corporate pace. The score of 3.2 reflects the genuine skill gaps. The culture fit is moderate: better than most roles in this batch on the structure side (remote, variety, reset-per-client), weaker on the mission and domain side.

Overall personality/culture fit: Moderate

Note: This is the strongest culture fit among the three GitLab roles in terms of role mechanics. Fully remote, repeated discovery cycles, EMEA variety. Apply with explicit acknowledgment of the SOW learning curve.

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

professional services, engagement manager, SOW, staffing plans, DevSecOps, discovery, pre-sales, outcome-based, EMEA, remote, stakeholder management, executive communication, facilitation, negotiation, asynchronous, CI/CD, GitLab, enterprise software, trusted advisor, implementation roadmap

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: Engagement Manager - EMEA

Location: Remote

Job ID: 8467462002 | Requisition: 6102

Company: GitLab

Position Overview:

GitLab seeks a Senior Professional Services Engagement Manager for its EMEA region. This role focuses on structuring services engagements that establish partnerships and shared success with customers, translating complex DevSecOps initiatives into measurable outcomes.

Key Responsibilities:

- Conducting discovery sessions with prospects and Systems Integrators
- Designing services proposals aligned with customer success metrics
- Developing custom-scoped SOWs and staffing plans
- Managing escalations and guiding customers through commercial processes
- Positioning consulting and training solutions to ensure customer retention
- Driving measurable outcomes through structured services that support customer success metrics
- Designing outcome-based professional services engagements
- Partnering with account executives and solutions architects to create implementation roadmaps
- Building trusted advisor relationships with technical leaders
- Managing the entire engagement lifecycle from discovery through delivery transition
- Influencing across cross-functional teams

Required Qualifications:

- Progressive experience structuring and selling professional services engagements
- Proven success in pre-sales discovery and developing custom SOWs for complex implementations
- Understanding of software development lifecycle practices
- Executive-level communication abilities
- Facilitation and negotiation expertise
- Comfort working cross-functionally in remote, asynchronous environments

GitLab Benefits:

- Health and financial benefits
- Flexible paid time off
- Equity compensation
- Growth and development funds
- Parental leave
- Team member resource groups

Equal Opportunity Statement:

GitLab is an equal opportunity employer committed to merit-based employment practices regardless of protected characteristics, with accommodations available during recruitment.